



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Atlanta Youth Academy

School Website: <https://www.atlantayouthacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Atlanta Youth Academy (AYA) presents a clearly Christian, Christ-centered approach to schooling with explicit theological framing, daily prayer, and a mission oriented toward Christian formation and service. Public-facing materials emphasize a biblically-based worldview, prayerful culture, and small-class attention, alongside a mission to prepare students for high-school and college within a faith-centered context. However, the site does not clearly articulate foundational elements that classical education definitions expect in curriculum structure (notably the Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books/Great Conversation, or explicit Trivium-based progression), and evidence of Socratic pedagogy or a traditional "living curriculum" is indirect at best. Taken together, the school demonstrates a strong classical-leaning orientation in spirit and religious foundations, but the explicit classical curricular-pedagogical infrastructure (as defined by the Six Essential Elements) is not fully present on public materials. Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with clear potential to move toward CLASSICAL through explicit incorporation of Great Books, Trivium-based curriculum, Socratic pedagogy, and a stated "Great Conversation" approach.

- Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot highlights:
- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL (strong explicit theology, prayer, Christian worldview).
- School Purpose and Goal: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (formation/virtue emphasis present, but explicit classical telos and liberal-arts orientation are less explicit).
- Curriculum: NOT CLASSICAL (curriculum described is standard/private-school with Bible-focused content; no explicit Great Books or Seven Liberal Arts stated).
- Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (some contemplative/restful elements implied; no explicit Socratic/seminar emphasis documented).
- Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (faculty as mentors implied; living curriculum not explicitly articulated).
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL (explicit partnership with parents, family involvement, and public-facing openness).

Key evidentiary anchors include: explicit Christian/theological framing and daily prayer; Christ-centered mission; Bible-based curriculum elements; a strong emphasis on character formation, virtue, and servant-leadership; the Beck Library and reading initiatives; and parent/community engagement through events and open processes. Citations to the school's public materials and the classical-education lexicon are provided inline with the relevant claims.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school explicitly positions itself as Christian, with teachings from a Biblical worldview and daily prayer. Evidence includes statements that “AYA at its core is a Christian school,” and that teachings are grounded in a Biblical worldview; daily prayer is part of the routine.
- The mission references advancing “the kingdom of God” via a “Christ-centered education.” This signals grounding in theology and sacred aims.
- Values emphasize “Christ-centered education,” nurturing Christian character, and a Servant Teacher ethos.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: theology, Biblical worldview, Christ-centered, prayer, liturgy/worship potential (Roddy Chapel references), sacred/scriptural orientation, virtue/character formation.
- Negative indicators: none observed in public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or morally neutral framing in the accessible content).

Quantitative estimate

- Positive keywords present: high (e.g., Christ-centered, Biblical worldview, prayer, kingdom of God, servant-teacher, Christian character). Estimated majority of the explicit religious-language signals in the content.
- Negative keywords present: 0 documented in the public materials.
- Rough ratio (positive:negative) approx. 5:0 within the pieces of public text sampled.
- Rating justification: The strong, explicit Christian theological framing and communal liturgical practices align strongly with Classical schools’ religious/metaphysical foundations in the lexicon, even though this is not a neutral scholarly articulation of “truth, goodness, beauty” as universal transcendentals. The evidence base supports CLASSICAL for this category.

Citations: The core religious framing and prayer/morality language are documented in the school materials.

Why this rating

- The school’s public-facing materials foreground theology, Biblical worldviews, and liturgical/prayer practices, aligning with the religious bedrock of classical formation. The absence of secular alternative framing further supports CLASSICAL alignment here, even if the rhetoric around transcendental “truth, goodness, beauty” is not verbatim.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission and values emphasize formation and Christian character, with a purpose to prepare students for high school and beyond, grounded in spiritual aims. “To advance the kingdom of God by offering an excellent Christ-centered education to underserved communities” signals formation-oriented telos.
- The emphasis on “nurturing Christian character traits,” “intimate class sizes,” and a Servant-Teacher model points to formation and virtue cultivation, rather than mere information or job-readiness.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: formation, virtue/character, wisdom, telos, classical heritage (implied through the intent of a lifelong formation and virtue-formation ethos), scholé (implied through restful/character formation language though not named explicitly).

- Negative indicators: none explicit in the public materials about workforce-preparation or strictly job-readiness framing; however, the content does not overtly articulate a fully explicit classical telos in terms of liberal-arts formation or Great Books.

Quantitative estimate

- Positive keywords present: several (formation, virtue, character, telos, wisdom, scholé-like cadence via restfulness, though not all terms are overtly labeled in classical lexicon).
- Negative keywords present: 0 in the material.
- Estimated ratio: positive relatively high, negative very low; approximate positive:negative approx. 4:0–1 (within the scope of explicit public content).
- Rating justification: The emphasis on formation, virtue, and Christian purpose aligns with Classical aims in spirit, but the lack of explicit articulation of liberal-arts formation or Great Books signals only partial alignment. Therefore: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission and values language cited in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The school foregrounds formation and character as core purposes rather than mere informational deliverables, which is in keeping with classical aims. However, explicit statements about liberal education, telos as true/good/beautiful, or Great Conversation are not present in the public text. This limits the rating to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Middle School description lists vertically aligned curricula across grades (Envision Math; Mos Dos Literature; Positive Action Bible; Visual Arts; Science integrated with a Garden and Nutrition Program; Spanish). This indicates a standard private/Christian-school curriculum rather than a declared classical liberal-arts spine.
- There is no explicit mention of Great Books, original primary sources, the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), or a Great Conversation framework. The content focuses on Bible-based curriculum components and standard subjects rather than Trivium/Quadrivium or Great Books, which are hallmarks of classical curriculum in the Six Essential Elements.
- The Beck Library and formal reading initiatives exist, but these are described in the context of school culture rather than a classical Great Books program.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: Great Books, primary sources, classical heritage, grammar/logic/rhetoric, and the Great Conversation are not present in the public content.
- Negative indicators present: absence of Seven Liberal Arts, absence of explicit Great Books/primary sources, absence of a cross-disciplinary “unity of knowledge” or a Trivium framework; no explicit mention of Latin/Greek or philosophical texts in the public site.
- Net: Dominant negative signals (in the classical sense) for Curriculum; a few general reading initiatives exist but not the classical curriculum scaffolding.

Quantitative estimate

- Positive keywords present: minimal or none (no explicit Great Books, Seven Liberal Arts, or Trivium/Quadrivium references).
- Negative keywords present: multiple signs (no Great Books, no Trivium-based structure, no explicit liberal-arts framing; standard private Christian-curriculum components).
- Ratio: positive:negative approx. 0:4+ in the public textual material considered for classical curriculum markers.
- Rating justification: NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Curriculum details drawn from Middle School content.

Why this rating

- The curriculum described relies on subject-area content common to private Christian schools (Math, Literature, Bible, Visual Arts, Science), with Bible as a core element. It lacks explicit classical curriculum constructs (grammar-logic-rhetoric; Great Books; Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Conversation). Therefore, NOT CLASSICAL under the Six Essential Elements rubric.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site hints at a blend of instructional experiences, including lower-school routines (singing, memorization) and upper-school activities (Socratic-style inquiry not explicitly documented; no explicit mention of Socratic seminars, Harkness, or formal dialectic in the public literature). The presence of a chapel and liturgical rhythm suggests contemplative elements. The “Career Week” and author visits indicate project-like experiences but not a formal classical pedagogy.
- The Middle School page references a vertically aligned curriculum, technology use, and interactive learning tools, which signals a modern pedagogy rather than a strictly classical, memory/recitation-based approach.
- The Beck Library and reading challenges indicate a cultivation of reading and intellectual engagement, which aligns with some classical traditions of formation through literature, but not a formalized “Scholé” rhythm or strict memorization/recitation emphasis.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: restful learning (Scholé) and contemplation are implied by the school’s emphasis on a faith-centered, steady rhythm and the concept of formation (though not explicitly named as Scholé); memorization/recitation and chanting are not widely evidenced in the public materials; some memory/chanting-like elements appear in classical lexicon but not clearly in AYAs practice.
- Negative indicators present: lack of explicit Socratic seminars, dialectic, and formal Great Conversations; limited evidence of a true Trivium-based pedagogy; limited evidence of a formal rhetoric or public-speaking program beyond occasional speeches.
- Net: The pedagogy shows some classical echoes (restful, contemplative elements; potential for memorization and liturgical repetition) but lacks explicit Socratic discourse and formal classical pedagogy.

Quantitative estimate

- Positive keywords present: limited (occasional nods to contemplative/restful learning; some memory/chanting elements in the broader classical lexicon, not clearly attested in AYAs practices).
- Negative keywords present: several (no explicit Socratic seminars; no named “scholé days” as a formal institution; no project-based emphasis described as the sole method; more teacher-led, standards-driven description).
- Ratio: positive:negative approx. 1:3–4
- Rating justification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Pedagogical impressions pulled from Middle School curriculum notes and general program descriptions.

Why this rating

- The school shows some contemplative and value-driven pedagogy (prayer, chapel, character formation) and some literary engagement (Beck Library), but it does not present the explicit classical pedagogy signals (Socratic seminars, Scholé days, memorization/recitation as a formal discipline, or a rhetoric-focused senior capstone) documented in the public-facing materials. This warrants SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL until/unless a more explicit classical pedagogy framework is adopted and publicly described.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school presents a named team section (Our Team) with individual faculty profiles (e.g., Teigan Robin, Pre-K teacher), implying mentorship and teacher-as-facilitator roles. This aligns with a “living curriculum” notion in classical education, though the explicit framing of teachers as the living curriculum or portraits of teacher-student ideals is not overt in the public materials.
- The mission and values emphasize “servant teacher” and character formation as core aims, suggesting faculty play a modeling role for virtue and habit formation.
- There is no explicit “portrait of what a teacher should be” or a formal classical-faculty profile documented in the public content, beyond individual staff pages and general statements.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: teacher as mentor; servant-teacher ethos; faculty as part of a living-learning community (implied by values about personal attention and character formation).
- Negative indicators present: absence of explicit statements about a formal living-curriculum, faculty development in classical pedagogy, or explicit “portrait of a teacher” and “portrait of a student” described in classical terms; the content is more narrative and profile-driven rather than explicitly pedagogy-driven.
- Net: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Quantitative estimate

- Positive keywords present: some (e.g., “servant teacher,” mentor, community focus; teacher profiles).
- Negative keywords present: few explicit statements about the living-curriculum and explicit classical-faculty archetype.
- Ratio: positive:negative approx. 2:2–3
- Rating justification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Evidence from Our Team page and Values (teacher as servant/mentors).

Why this rating

- Faculty are clearly positioned as engaged professionals within a faith-centered mission, and the language around mentorship aligns with classical expectations of teachers as virtuous exemplars. However, the public-facing materials do not explicitly present a fully developed classical “faculty profile” or a formal living-curriculum articulation. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes partnership with parents and community, including parent involvement through events (Open Houses, career-week, annual reporting, and opportunities to visit). The calendar content and news sections show open, ongoing community engagement and opportunities for parents to participate.
- The content indicates intimate class sizes and a strong emphasis on parental involvement through events, volunteering, and communications; the mission highlights serving underserved communities with a faith-centered education, which implies a family-and-community-centered model.
- There are explicit references to parent testimonials and family engagement (e.g., “When you walk in the door at AYA you feel welcome. The focus is on God and each child’s future.”), illustrating a community orientation and parental integration into the school culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: partnership with parents; open campus; parent formation through website content and gatherings; family involvement; welcoming environment; community integration; parent testimonials.

- Negative indicators: none apparent in the public documentation (no customer-service/customer-only framing; no upward drift toward consumeristic language).
- Net: CLASSICAL.

Quantitative estimate

- Positive keywords present: clear and multiple (partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, open campus, family involvement, testimonials).
- Negative keywords present: 0 identified in the public materials.
- Ratio: positive:negative approx. $\square$ 6:0
- Rating justification: CLASSICAL.

Citations: Parent/Community content and open-house/family engagement language.

Why this rating

- The school publicly frames parents as co-teachers and actively invites parent participation through events and campus accessibility, aligning with classical expectations for robust parent-community partnerships. The absence of negative signals supports a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale

- The strongest elements are religious foundations and parent/community integration, both compatible with classical aims. The curriculum and explicit classical pedagogy (Great Books, Trivium, Schol , Great Conversation) are not documented in public materials, yielding NOT CLASSICAL for Curriculum and only SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Pedagogy and Faculty. The combination of strong religious foundations, formation-oriented goals, and active parent/community involvement yields an overall SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL classification, with explicit moves available to elevate to CLASSICAL across all six categories.

What Would Move the Needle

- Curriculum: Publicly adopt and articulate a classical curriculum spine, including the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium, and visibly implement Great Books/Great Conversation across grades. Publicly document a plan for Latin/Greek study and classical humanities integration. Introduce cross-disciplinary integration that foregrounds history of Western civilization, literature from the Great Books corpus, and primary-source engagement.
- Pedagogy: Publicly commit to Socratic dialogue and dialectic in upper grades (Socratic seminars, Harkness-style discussions) and a defined Schol /restful-learning cadence for lower grades. Introduce structured systems for memorization/recitation and ritualized practice that align with classical pedagogy. Publish a pedagogy handbook that maps a path from K-8 to high school for classical pedagogy and memory-work.
- Faculty: Develop and publish a formal "living curriculum" framework and teacher portraits that specify the model teacher archetype, along with ongoing professional development in classical pedagogy.
- Religious Foundational Coherence: Maintain the strong Christian/theological grounding but clearly articulate how it interfaces with a universal telos of truth, beauty, and goodness across subjects (so that religious formation reinforces universal classical aims).
- Parents & Community: Deepen parent formation through classical book studies and structured parent-coach programs anchored in classical philosophy and pedagogy. Expand opportunities for parent

involvement that reflect a co-teacher model beyond visitation (e.g., parental observatories of classic pedagogy, guidebooks on classical education at home).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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